

120 Years of Olympic History: Participation and Medal Trends

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The Olympic Games is the most popular international sports competition that gathers the best sportsmen from all the world every four years. Since their modern revival in Athens in 1896, the Games have expanded enormously in scale, diversity and global importance. Studying historical trends in Olympic participation and performance can shed light on wider trends in gender equality, national development and sporting investment. This report looks at athlete-level data over 120 years of Olympic history to bring out key trends in participation and medal outcomes.

The dataset, from Kaggle (rgriffin 2018), contains over 271,000 observations of athletes, sports, events, and medal results from Summer and Winter Games. The analysis is restricted to the Summer Olympics to ensure comparability of similar events. The analysis is guided by three key questions: How has gender participation changed over time? Which countries have historically dominated the medal tallies? How has Australia performed relative to other countries? The findings aim to provide a data-based view on the evolution of the Olympic movement.

rgriffin. 2018. *120 Years of Olympic History: Athletes and Results*. <https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/heesoo37/120-years-of-olympic-history-athletes-and-results>.